Harlow's Big Adventure – Storyline Revised 10.6.2026
Possible other titles. Harlow's Accidental Journey or Harlow's Unexpected Journey

Page 1 - before
Hey there! My name is Harlow. I'm a pretty laid-back Ragdoll cat, and I live the good life with Lois right here in sunny Long Beach, California. Honestly, my favorite pastimes pretty much boil down to eating, sleeping, and then eating some more. Want to come along with me? I want to share a wild, unexpected journey I had recently. As the saying goes, cats are naturally curious creatures, but this isn't really a story about curiosity—it's a story of kindness and generosity, and I think you're going to love it.

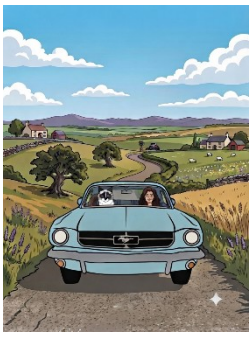
10.6.2026 changes
Hey there! I'm Harlow, a laid-back Ragdoll cat living the good life in sunny Long Beach, California with my best human friend, Lois. My favorite pastimes boil down to eating, sleeping, and eating some more. I want to share a wild, unexpected journey I had recently—not a story about cat curiosity, but one of kindness and generosity of others that I think you'll love.





Page 2 - before
A few days ago, Lois hit me with, "Hey Harlow, want to go take a drive out to Farrelli Farms and grab some fresh fruits and veggies?" I thought that sounded like an awesome idea, so we hopped in her classic '65 Mustang and took off for a nice little day trip out to the country.

10.6.2026 changes
A few days ago, Lois asked, "Hey Harlow, want to drive out to Farrelli Farms for some fresh fruits and veggies and enjoy the country scenery?" Sounded awesome to me, so we hopped into her classic '65 Mustang for a nice day trip to the country.



Farm Visit

Page 3 - before
“Ah, we finally made it," I sighed, taking in the rolling green fields, as we pulled into Farrelli Farms. Lois was already practically shaking with excitement; her eyes locked on a vibrant display of heirloom tomatoes and fresh berries. "Oh, look at these, they look incredible!" she said, completely mesmerized. Seeing she was entirely in her element inspecting the produce, I smiled up at her and decided I would go stretch my legs and wander around the farm for a bit."

10.6.2026 changes
“Ah, we finally made it,” I sighed, taking in the rolling green fields as we pulled into Farrelli Farms. Lois was practically shaking with excitement, her eyes locked on a vibrant display of heirloom tomatoes and fresh berries. Seeing her completely mesmerized and in her element, I smiled and decided to wander off to stretch my legs.



Page 4 - before
"Phew, it is *toasty* out here today!" Sweet Pea the pig grunted, happily splashing around in a big, gooey puddle. "Come on in! The mud is where it's at, if you want to beat the heat." My tail was twitching, as I crept up to the edge of the thick, brown sludge. I carefully dipped one paw in, then quickly yanked it back, wrinkling my nose. "Oof, I appreciate the tip, I really do... but have you seen my coat? This gorgeous fur does *not* do mud." "Are you sure? It feels amazing!" Sweet Pea snorted, tossing a little muck onto her back with a happy wiggle. "Oh, it definitely feels cool, I'll give you that," I said, politely backing up a few steps and dusting off my paw. "It was lovely meeting you and all, but I think I need to go track down a sprinkler or something—before I ruin my look. Catch you later!"

10.6.2026 changes
“Phew, it’s toasty today!” grunted Sweet Pea the pig, happily splashing in a big puddle. “Come on in! The mud is where it’s at to beat the heat.” I crept to the edge and carefully stepped in, then quickly jumped back, wrinkling my nose. “I appreciate the tip, but have you seen my coat? This fur does not do mud.” “Are you sure? It feels amazing!” Sweet Pea snorted, wiggling happily. “It looks

inviting, but I think I'll find another way to cool off that won't ruin my look," I said, politely backing away while trying to lick off the mud. "Lovely meeting you, catch you later!"



Page 5 - before
It didn't take me long to spot a gorgeous little pond surrounded by blooming flowers, with a sweet family of ducks paddling around in the middle. I hadn't even made it to the edge before Mama Fiona and her three ducklings—Missi, Sammi, and Lili—swam right over to say hello. Fiona took one look at my crusty crud-covered coat and shook her head. "Oh, honey, you look miserable! Come on in and take a dip to get that nasty mud off. Trust me, you'll feel so much better in no time." Now, let's be real—normally, the last thing in the world a cat wants is to be soaked in water. But desperate times call for desperate measures! I trusted Fiona's advice, took a deep breath, and hopped in. And you know what? It felt *amazing*. Once I scrambled back onto the dry grass, I gave a vigorous shake to fluff out my fur, thanked Fiona and the girls for saving the day, and continued on my way.

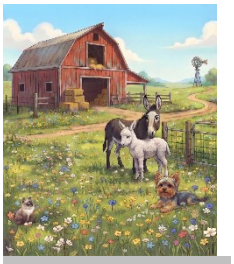
10.6.2026 changes
I soon spotted a gorgeous pond with a family of ducks—Mama Fiona and her ducklings, Missi, Sammi, and Lili—who swam right over. Seeing my crusty coat, Fiona urged, "Oh honey, you look miserable! Come take a dip to get that mud off." Normally, a cat avoids water at all costs, but desperate times call for desperate measures. I took a deep breath and hopped in. It felt amazing! Scrambling back onto the dry grass, I shook out my fur, thanked Fiona and her girls for saving the day, and set off again.



Page 6 - before
I was having a great time strolling around the farm and meeting everyone, but after a while, I looked around and had the sudden, sinking feeling that I had wandered off way too far from Lois. As I stood there looking around, Molly the donkey and her adorable little baby, Albie, trotted over. Molly took one look at my worried face and chuckled gently. "Feeling a bit turned around, little

guy? Here, take a look at our big ears. Let that be a reminder to always really listen to your surroundings if you ever find yourself in a tight spot." That actually made a lot of sense. I lifted my head high, swiveled my ears left and right like radar dishes, and sure enough, I caught the faint sound of people talking in the distance. "That's brilliant! Thank you Molly!" I called out, giving her and Albie a grateful nod, as I picked up my pace toward the sound of the voices.

10.6.2026 changes
After a while, I realized I'd wandered far from Lois. Sensing my panic, Molly the donkey and her baby, Albie, trotted over. "Feeling turned around, little guy?" Molly chuckled gently. "Take a look at our big ears. Let them remind you to really listen to your surroundings when you're in a tight spot." Taking her advice, I swiveled my ears left and right like radar dishes and caught the faint sound of people talking. "That's brilliant! Thank you, Molly!" I called out, nodding to her and Albie before picking up my pace toward the voices.



Page 7 - before
As I was zipping along, I heard a sound that caught me totally off guard- someone was giggling! Now, hearing a horse chuckle is weird on a *good* day, but as I got closer, I realized the sound was coming straight from Chester, a retired racehorse. Totally baffled, I walked up and asked him what was so hilarious. Chester let out a snort, and shaking his head, he said. "Well, little guy, I heard someone coming my way, but because you're so tiny and low to the ground, I couldn't actually see who it was. At first, it startled me, so I started chuckling as a defense mechanism. Back on the racetrack, life got pretty rough, so I trained myself to keep a sense of humor no matter what. But honestly? You're just so darn cute, I couldn't help it." I couldn't even be mad at that. "Fair enough!" I said with a smile. "I'll definitely keep that in mind. Right now, though, I need to figure out how to find my way back to where I started this journey."

10.6.2026 changes
As I zipped along, I heard someone giggling—which came straight from Chester, a retired racehorse. Baffled, I asked what was so hilarious. "Well, little guy, you're so tiny that I couldn't see who was coming, which startled me and made me snicker." Chester snorted, shaking his head. "I started chuckling as a defense mechanism—back on the racetrack, life got rough, so I learned to keep a sense of humor, which helped ease the stress." "Fair enough!" I smiled. "I'll keep that in mind. Right now, though, I need to find my way back to where I started."



Page 8 - before

Before I knew it, I started hearing voices up ahead—Lois had to be close by. I got so excited just thinking about all of the stories I couldn't wait to tell her about my little farming expedition. With my head completely in the clouds, I totally missed the bright red pickup truck parked nearby, getting loaded down with crates of fresh fruits and vegetables for a city delivery. The farm hands were rushing around like crazy, and before I knew what hit me, I accidentally got scooped up and loaded right into the back of the truck while they weren't looking. Next thing I knew, the engine roared to life and we were speeding away—and I was definitely headed straight for the big city. *Yikes!*

10.6.2026 changes

Hearing voices ahead, I got so excited that I stopped paying attention. I completely missed a bright red pickup truck being loaded with fruit and vegetable crates for a city delivery. In the rush, farm hands accidentally scooped me up and loaded me into the back. Before I knew it, the engine roared to life, and we were speeding off toward the big city. *Yikes!*



City Visit

Page 9 - before

That truck was flying down the highway at top speed, so I didn't have many options other than to hunker down and wait it out until we finally came to a stop. Hours later, we rolled into the bustling city. The second the engine cut and the workers hopped out, I bolted. I was free, sure—but looking around at the towering buildings and roaring traffic, my stomach dropped. I had no idea where I was, or how on earth I was going to find my way back home.

10.6.2026 changes

With the truck flying down the highway, I hunkered down until we finally rolled into the bustling city hours later. The second the engine stopped, I bolted. I was free—but looking up at the

towering buildings in this unfamiliar city with roaring traffic, my stomach dropped. I was completely lost and had no idea how to get home.



Page 10 - before

I started aimlessly wandering down the city sidewalks, and my stomach let out a loud, pathetic rumble—man, it had been forever since breakfast. Darting down a side alley to catch my breath, I spied something wild - a rat just chilling there, casually going to town on a slice of pizza. Even though I was a little spooked, hunger won out. I tiptoed up timidly and asked if there was any way I could snag a bite. Philly—that was his name—flashed a big grin and pushed the box closer. "Sure thing! Help yourself, man." As we sat there munching away, Philly puffed out his chest a little. "You know, I'm kind of a big deal around here. I've actually been photographed and ended up in the papers plenty of times for my gourmet pizza-heists." "No way!" I said, my eyes going wide. "You must have been doing this forever. You're a total pro at pinching food—think you could teach me your ways?" Philly flashed a sly smile. "Oh, you know it," he said, and right then and there, he started giving me a masterclass in alleyway foraging.

10.6.2026 changes

As I wandered the city sidewalks, my stomach let out a loud rumble. I darted down an alley to catch my breath and spotted something wild—Philly the rat was casually going to town on a slice of pizza. Hunger won out over fear. I timidly asked for a bite, and Philly happily pushed the box over. "Sure thing! Help yourself, man," he grinned. As we munched, Philly puffed out his chest. "I'm kind of a big deal around here. I've been in the papers plenty of times for my gourmet pizza heists." "No way!" I said. "You're a total pro—think you could teach me your ways?" With a sly smile, Philly agreed, launching into a masterclass in alleyway foraging right then and there.



Page 11 - before

Feeling completely full, and glad I'd run into a kind soul in the city, I figured it was time to find a nice, quiet spot to figure out how to get back home to Long Beach. I ditched the crazy traffic and noise and wandered over to Midtown Park, where I spotted a lovely lady walking a super elegant dog. As they strolled past, I piped up, "Hey there! I'm Harlow. What's your name, and could you

possibly help me find my way back to Long Beach?" Penelope the Afghan Hound just tossed her head in the air and replied, "I'm sorry, but I am *much* too busy to stop and talk to you." For the life of me, I could not see what she was supposedly so busy doing—she just came across as totally snooty. And don't even get me started on the stray calico cat sitting nearby - that cat couldn't be bothered to help me out either.

10.6.2026 changes
Stuffed and grateful for Philly's help, I wandered into Midtown Park to find a quiet spot and figure out a way back home to Long Beach. I spotted an elegant dog with her owner and piped up, "Hey there! I'm Harlow. Could you help me find my way back to Long Beach?" Penelope the Afghan Hound snobbishly tossed her head and replied, "I'm much too busy to talk to you."—though she wasn't doing anything at all. A nearby stray calico couldn't be bothered to help either.



Page 12 - before
With Penelope's bad attitude, my faith in human nature was taking a pretty big hit. When I came out of the other side of the park, I realized I'd wandered into a definitely *not*-so-great part of town. That's when I spotted another four-legged creature heading my way. He looked like he'd been through the ringer, but friendly enough. Otis the coyote stopped, gave me a look, and said, "Hey there, my friend, can I help you out with something?" I let out a huge sigh of relief and said, "Yes, thank you! I am just so glad someone is finally willing to help. Do you have any idea how to get to Long Beach?" Otis shook his head. "Ah, man, I wish I could help, but I've been living on these streets for so long I honestly don't know anything about anywhere else. Good luck, though—and let me give you one piece of advice - *never* let your guard down around here." I thanked him kindly and headed off down the next street.

10.6.2026 changes
After Penelope's bad attitude, my faith was taking a hit. Exiting the park into a rougher part of town, I spotted Otis the coyote. He looked like he'd been through the ringer, but friendly enough. "Hey there, my friend, can I help you out?" Otis asked. I let out a huge sigh of relief. "Yes, thank you! Do you know how to get to Long Beach?" Otis shook his head. "I wish I could help, but I've lived on these streets so long I don't know anywhere else. Good luck—and never let your guard down around here." I thanked him and headed off down the street.



Page 13 - before
Armed with Otis' tip to always keep my guard up, I felt a whole lot more confident about asking people for help. But before I even had the chance to speak with anyone, Gideon the pigeon spotted me from high up on a ledge as I struggled to get anyone's attention. So, he swooped right down and chirped, "You look a little lost, buddy. Where are you trying to go?" "I'm trying to find my way back to Long Beach. Do you think you can help me?" I replied. "This might be a bit of a long shot," Gideon said, "but if you can make it over to the baseball park, someone there might actually be able to help. It's only a few blocks away." Pointing his wing toward the ball park, he added, "This is about the best I can do, seeing as I'm a city bird and never leave the urban boundaries. Wishing you the best of luck, though!" I was super grateful for the advice and immediately set off in the direction of the ballpark.

10.6.2026 changes
Armed with Otis' tip to keep my guard up, I felt much more confident asking for help. Before I could even speak to anyone, Gideon the pigeon spotted me from a high ledge and swooped down. "You look lost, buddy. Where are you trying to go?" he chirped. "I'm trying to find my way back to Long Beach. Do you think you can help?" I replied. "It's a bit of a long shot, but if you can make it to the baseball park a few blocks away, someone there might be able to help," Gideon said, pointing his wing toward it. "That's about the best I can do, being a city bird who never leaves the urban boundaries. Best of luck!" Grateful for the tip, I immediately set off toward the ballpark.



Baseball Park Visit

Page 14 - before
Finding the ballpark was a breeze, and I managed to slip in without anyone noticing me. The place was buzzing with the roaring crowd, but cutting through all the happy noise, I heard a flurry of frantic *chitter-chatter*! I looked over and spotted a nervous little squirrel trying to scramble up a tall pole, his paws spinning in circles. "Hey there, my name is Harlow!" I called out, as I moseyed on over. "Who are you, and what's the big emergency?" He spun around, and squeaked. "Hi! I'm Chippy, and I'm racing to the top of this pole because I just *know* there are peanuts waiting up there for me!" "Oh man, peanuts sound *amazing*!" I said, my tail swishing with excitement. "Can you teach me the secret ninja art of pole-climbing?" Chippy paused, squinting down at me and replied. "Sure, I can show you, but I think you'd probably have better luck scavenging on the ground, where baseball fans drop buttery popcorn and snacks everywhere." I thought that this made total sense—why climb a pole when the floor is basically a giant treasure hunt? "Fair point!" I thanked my new fuzzy friend and scampered off to explore the rest of the park.

10.6.2026 changes

Finding the ballpark was a breeze, and I slipped inside unnoticed. Amid the roaring crowd, I heard frantic chittering and spotted a nervous squirrel trying to scramble up a tall pole. “Hey, I’m Harlow!” I called out. “What’s the emergency?” “I’m Chippy, and I’m racing up this pole for peanuts!” he squeaked. “Peanuts sound amazing!” I said. “Can you teach me how to pole-climb?” Chippy squinted at me. “Sure, but you’d have better luck on the ground where fans drop buttery popcorn and snacks everywhere.” Realizing the floor was a giant treasure hunt, I agreed. “Fair point!” I thanked my new friend and scampered off to explore the park.



Page 15 - before

I had *never* laid eyes on an actual baseball game before, so I was totally clueless. From what I could tell, it was just a bunch of guys in matching pajamas running around a giant green field and tossing a little white ball back and forth. Suddenly, the ground started to shake. *Boom, boom, boom!* Out charged a colossal, fuzzy, bear-like character straight out of the dugout, waving his giant paws in the air! “HELLO EVERYBODY! I’m The Hibernator, your super-duper team mascot! Who’s up for some fun?!” he roared in a voice that shook the snack stands. “*I* AM! *ME! ME!*” I yelled right back, waving my paws high in the air. Even though a tiny, gloomy shadow of doubt started creeping into my heart—telling me I’d never, ever make it back home to Lois—I suddenly remembered Chester’s golden rule. The wise old racehorse had told me with a wink: *"Always keep a sense of humor, no matter what life hands you—even if it's a giant fuzzy bear!"*

10.6.2026 changes

Having never seen a baseball game, I was totally clueless—it just looked like guys in matching pajamas running around tossing a ball. Suddenly, the ground shook. *Boom, boom, boom!* Out charged a colossal, fuzzy, bear-like character waving giant paws. “HELLO EVERYBODY! I’m The Hibernator, your team mascot! Who’s ready for fun?!” he roared. “I AM!” I yelled, waving my paws. Even as a shadow of doubt crept in about getting back to Lois, I remembered Chester’s golden rule: *Always keep a sense of humor, no matter what—even if life hands you a giant fuzzy bear!*



Page 16 - before

The Hibernator gave me the comic relief I desperately needed, but once the show was over, the reality of being lost set back in, and I started feeling pretty lonely and scared. Looking up into the stands, I spotted a super friendly, smiling face looking down at me, and I decided to wander over to chat. "Howdy," he said. "I'm Edward the Emotional Support Dog, and this is my friend, Jon, sitting right next to me. You look like your spirits are a little down." "Oh man, you have no idea," I said. "I'm totally lost and can't figure out how to get home." Edward gave a sympathetic look and said, "I'm so sorry to hear that. But hey, with a little patience and persistence, I'm sure you'll find the help you need soon. If you want, come on over and give me a hug—sometimes that helps." I didn't hesitate for a second, gave Edward the biggest hug ever, which felt great.

10.6.2026 changes

The Hibernator's comedy provided some relief, but as the show ended, fear and loneliness set back in. Looking into the stands, I spotted a friendly face and wandered over. "Howdy," he said. "I'm Edward the Emotional Support Dog, and this is my friend, Jon. You look a little down in the dumps." "I'm totally lost and can't figure out how to get home," I confessed. "I'm so sorry," Edward offered sympathetically. "With patience and persistence, you'll find help. Come give me a hug if you want." I didn't hesitate, wrapping Edward in the biggest hug ever, which instantly made me feel better.



Page 17 - before

That comforting hug from Edward and his kind words were just what I needed right then. Between that and gobbling up some peanuts I'd found on the ground, my mouth was totally parched, so I wandered over to the snack shack to track down some water. Thank goodness the people working there left out bowls of water for pets passing by! While I was lapping it up, I heard a little buzzing right above my head. "Hey, what's a cat like you doing hanging out at a ballpark?" Jasmine the bumblebee asked. "I'm just trying to find someone to help me figure out my way back home to Long Beach," I answered. Jasmine lit up and said, "Oh, no way! I actually have friends who live in Long Beach, and I know the exact route. You can follow me from up above. Ready? Just follow my buzz!" I took one last quick sip of water, and just like that, we hit the road toward Long Beach.

10.6.2026 changes

Edward's hug and a few dropped peanuts restored my spirits, but my mouth was parched. I wandered over to the snack shack, where kind workers had left out water bowls for pets. As I lapped it up, a buzzing sounded above my head. "What's a cat like you doing at a ballpark?" asked Jasmine the bumblebee. "I'm trying to find my way back to Long Beach," I answered. Jasmine lit up. "No way! I have friends in Long Beach and know the exact route. Follow me from up above—just follow my buzz!" Taking one last sip, I hit the road toward Long Beach right behind her.



Beach Visit

Page 18 - before
Following Jasmine was super easy. She eventually took off to go hang out with her friends, and just like that, I found myself sitting right on the sand, looking out at the gorgeous ocean. It felt like I was getting close to home, even though I wasn't quite there yet. As I strolled along the shoreline, I thought I'd spotted some kind of funny little toy, but it turned out to be a crab walking completely sideways! "Hey, are you alright?" I asked. "You seem to be moving in a pretty strange way." "Yes, I'm fine, thank you! That's just how we roll. My name is Babs. What's yours, and are *you* alright?" she shot back. "My name is Harlow, and I'm just wondering if you can help me get home," I said. Babs sighed. "Ah, no, sorry, I can't help with that. You see, us crabs can only walk sideways, so we can't even see what's coming straight ahead of us. But let me give you a quick tip - be super careful trying to make it the rest of the way home. Always look in every single direction before crossing streets, just to be safe." I thanked her for the advice and kept meandering along the beach.

10.6.2026 changes
Following Jasmine was easy, and when she buzzed off to meet friends, I found myself sitting on the sand looking out at the gorgeous ocean. Strolling along the shoreline, I spotted a crab walking sideways. "Are you alright?" I asked. "You're moving pretty strangely." "Yes, I'm fine! That's just how we roll," she shot back. "I'm Babs. What's your name, and are *you* alright?" "I'm Harlow, and I'm trying to get back home," I replied. Babs sighed. "Sorry, I can't help. Us crabs only walk sideways, so we can't see what's straight ahead. But here's a tip: always look in every direction before crossing streets to stay safe." I thanked her for the advice and kept meandering down the beach.



Page 19 - before
Since I'm strictly an indoor land animal, I'd never actually seen the ocean before, so I snuck on up to the water's edge to get a closer look. Lo and behold, a giant shark suddenly surged out of the water, scaring me half to death! At first, I was totally frightened, but it turned out Finnegan the shark was just as spooked to see me standing on the shore, as I was to see him. Once we both caught our breath, we settled down and started chatting, and I shared my whole tale of woe. "I wish I could help you find your way back, but I obviously can't leave the water," Finnegan said. "Just remember that stepping into the ocean can be just as dangerous as wandering into any other unfamiliar place. If you don't know – don't go!" "Thanks, Finnegan. I'll definitely remember that," I said, before turning around and continuing on my way.

10.6.2026 changes
As an indoor land animal, I'd never seen the ocean, so I crept to the water's edge for a closer look. Suddenly, a giant shark surged out, scaring me half to death! It turned out Finnegan the shark was just as spooked by me. Once we caught our breath, I shared my woeful tale. "I wish I could help, but I can't leave the water," Finnegan said. "Just remember, stepping into the ocean is dangerous if you don't know it. If you don't know—don't go!" "Thanks, Finnegan. I'll remember that," I said, turning back toward land.



Page 20 - -before
As I was trudging along the soft sand and staring out at the rolling waves, *WHOOPS!*—I completely wiped out and tripped over something round and lumpy. Turns out, it wasn't a coconut or a big rock. It was a penguin, fast asleep right there on the sunny beach! Even to a wandering cat like me, that felt *super* bizarre. Penguins are supposed to be chilling on icebergs, not sunbathing in California! *SQUAWK!* Pebbles the penguin bolted upright, feathers ruffled and totally startled. "Hey, what gives? Can't you see I was having a first-class nap here?!" "Oh man, I am *so* sorry!" I blurted out, dusting sand off my paws. "I didn't see you at all! Uh... aren't you, like, a million miles away from home?" Pebbles slumped over, looking super dejected. "Yeah, you could say that. I took a wrong turn at a glacier, and now I'm totally lost. I have zero idea how to get back to my colony." I gave a sympathetic sigh. "I wish I could give you some travel advice, but I'm in the exact same boat—though, phew, I probably don't have quite as far to go as you do!" I gave him a gentle tail-wave. "Wishing you the best of luck, buddy. I really hope you find your way home safe and sound soon!"

10.6.2026 changes
As I trudged along the sand, I tripped over something round and lumpy—a penguin fast asleep on the sunny beach! *"SQUAWK!"* Pebbles the penguin bolted upright, ruffled and startled. "Can't you see I was taking a nap?!" "I am so sorry!" I blurted out. "I didn't see you! Aren't you a million miles from home?" Pebbles slumped dejectedly. "Yeah. I took a wrong turn at a glacier, and now I'm totally lost." "I'm in the exact same boat—though you have a much longer trip ahead," I sighed gently. "Wishing you luck, buddy. I hope you find your way home soon!"



Page 21 - before

As if tripping over a sleeping penguin wasn't enough, I suddenly felt a massive shadow pass over me and realized someone was flying right above me. Turns out it was a pelican patrolling the beach who'd spotted me wandering around. "Hey, little fella," she called out, circling down. "You look pretty exhausted and totally lost. Is there anything I can do to help?" I let out a weak little squeak and said, "Oh my, yes, please! Can you help me get back home? I don't think I'm super far away—I live right here in Long Beach, but I have no idea how to get there." "Say no more!" she replied with a smile. "Just call me Helga, and I'll be happy to give you a lift. I'll scoop you right up in my big throat pouch and carry you most of the way. I can't go all the way to your front door, but I can drop you off right at the start of your road—any closer, and I'd be way too far from the ocean." "That is more than okay, and I can't thank you enough," I said, as I was starting to breathe more easily now.

10.6.2026 changes
Just as I picked myself up, a massive shadow swept over me. A pelican patrolling the beach circled down and called out, "Hey little fella, you look exhausted and lost. Can I help?" I let out a weak squeak. "Yes, please! I live right here in Long Beach, but I have no idea how to get home." "Say no more!" she smiled. "I'm Helga. I'll scoop you up in my throat pouch and you can watch for familiar places. I'll drop you at the start of your road—that's as close as I can get without straying too far from the ocean." Breathing a sigh of relief, I replied, "That's beyond perfect. I can't thank you enough!"



Page 22 - before
Helga gently lowered my down at the beginning of my street, and much to my delight, familiar sights started popping up all around me. But even better, I suddenly got this strong feeling that I wasn't walking alone, even though nobody was actually in sight. *"Could it be that Guardian Angels have been with me this whole time?"* I wondered to myself. *"I've always known those heavenly beings were watching over me."* Feeling a wave of peace, I gave a little knowing smile and a nod straight up into the air to thank my invisible caretakers—and right after that, I finally spotted my house coming into view!

10.6.2026 changes
Helga gently lowered me down and I started to recognize some familiar sites around me. But even better, I felt a strong sensation that I wasn't walking alone. *Could it be that Guardian Angels have been with me this whole time?* I wondered, feeling a wave of peace. I nodded toward the sky in silent thanks to my invisible caretakers—and right on cue, my house finally came into view!



Page 23 - before

And there it was, right in plain sight—MY HOME! *"Hooray! Hooray! I'm finally home!"* I shrieked, quivering with excitement. Lois must have heard the familiar pitter-patter of my little paws on the porch, because she whipped the door open in a flash and scooped me up, burying me in the biggest, tightest hugs and kisses ever. "Oh, my darling Harlow, where have you been?!" she gasped, her eyes shining. "I was out of my mind with worry, but now I'm just filled with so much joy that you're finally back home. Come on inside and get warm—I've got a delicious tuna dinner waiting just for you!"

10.6.2026 changes

There it was, right in plain sight—MY HOME! *"Hooray! I'm finally home!"* I shrieked, quivering with excitement. Lois must have heard my paws on the porch, because she whipped the door open and scooped me up into the biggest, tightest hug. "Oh, my darling Harlow, where have you been?!" she gasped, eyes shining. "I was out of my mind with worry, but I'm so happy you're back. Come inside—I've got a delicious tuna dinner waiting for you!"



or kissing



Page 24 - before

Feeling more comfortable than I've ever felt, I settled in and looked back on everything that had happened to me. I'm still completely blown away by how kind, generous, and genuinely helpful total strangers were to me all day. I know it's impossible to actually repay them, so I figured the next best thing to do would be to pay it forward the very first chance I get. As I lounge here, nice and warm in front of the cozy fireplace in my own living room, I think I've already spotted who that first lucky recipient is going to be. "I see you over there, my little chum," I whispered, looking over toward the corner. "How would you like some cheese?"

10.6.2026 changes

Settled warmly in front of my cozy fireplace, I looked back on everything that happened. I was completely blown away by how kind and helpful total strangers had been. Since I couldn't repay

them, I decided to pay it forward at the very first chance I got. Looking toward the corner near the fireplace, I spotted my first lucky recipient. "I see you over there, my little chum," I whispered with a smile. "How would you like some cheese?"



The End